

VM Password Reset_RDP SSH

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Tags

cw.RDP-SSH

cw.Workflow

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Short URL

<https://aka.ms/azpwdreset>

Scenario

Customer needs to reset the password on an Azure Virtual Machine.

Data Collection

Get from the customer

- Is this a single or multiple IDs kind of issues?
- Is this happening on domain, local IDs or both type of IDs?
- If this is happening on a single ID, what is the ID?

Root Cause Analysis

The reason why the customer cannot access with a given account could be due to multiple factors:

1. Customer Education.

1. Ensure the customer is trying to access correctly using the correct user/ip:

1. In Windows, if the customer wants to use a local ID, ensure that the customer is providing the correct authentication context to the RDP app:

Correct ways to provide the correct authentication context to the RDP app are:

```
\<<username>>  
DOMAIN\<<username>>  
IP\<<username>>  
<<username>>@IP  
..\<<username>>
```

All the following ways are incorrect

```
.\<<username>>  
<<username>>
```

2. Trying to access to the correct VM (IP and name)

2. Check if the account is not expired nor disabled.

1. In Windows, if the customer wants to reset the local Built-in Administrator account then:

1. You will be able to confirm this by checking **WinGuestAnalyzer\Health Signal** tab and the status of the built-in administrator account:



```
{  
  "accounts": {  
    "windows": {  
      "adminAccountPasswordExpired": false,  
      "adminAccountDisabled": true  
    }  
  }  
}
```

2. If the account is disabled, then refer to [The user account is currently disabled and cannot be used](#)

3. In Windows, the VMAGENT extension could be broken or not installed

1. Check if the agent is running normally. You can check this on **WinGuestAnalyzer\Health Signal** tab on the *services* section:

```
▼ "services": [  
  ▼ {  
    "name": "TermService",  
    "state": "Running",  
    "startMode": "Manual"  
  },  
  ▼ {  
    "name": "BFE",  
    "state": "Running",  
    "startMode": "Auto"  
  },  
  ▼ {  
    "name": "MpsSvc",  
    "state": "Running",  
    "startMode": "Auto"  
  },  
  ▼ {  
    "name": "WindowsAzureGuestAgent",  
    "state": "Running",  
    "startMode": "Auto"  
  },  
  ▼ {  
    "name": "WindowsAzureTelemetryService",  
    "state": "Running",  
    "startMode": "Auto"  
  },  
  ▼ {  
    "name": "RdAgent",  
    "state": "Running",  
    "startMode": "Auto"  
  },  
],
```

Reference

- [How to reset local Windows password for Azure VM](#)
- [How to reset the Remote Desktop service or its login password in a Windows VM](#)
- [Troubleshoot SSH connections to an Azure Linux VM that fails, errors out, or is refused](#)
- [CIS Password Policy Guide: Passphrases, Monitoring, and More](#)
- [MS-ISAC Security Primer – Securing Login Credentials](#)

Tracking close code for this volume

Root Cause	Product	Support Topic	Cause Tracking code	Bug
1	Azure Virtual Machine – Windows	Routing Azure Virtual Machine V3\Cannot Connect to my VM\I need to reset my password	Root Cause - Windows Azure\Virtual Machine\Password Reset\Customer Education	
	Azure Virtual Machine – Windows	Routing Azure Virtual Machine V3\Cannot Connect to my VM\I need to reset my password	Root Cause - Windows Azure\Virtual Machine\Password Reset\Domain Controller VM	
	Azure Virtual Machine – Windows	Routing Azure Virtual Machine V3\Cannot Connect to my VM\I need to reset my password	Root Cause - Windows Azure\Virtual Machine\Password Reset\Powershell or CLI issue	
	Azure Virtual Machine – Windows	Routing Azure Virtual Machine V3\Cannot Connect to my VM\I need to reset my password	Root Cause - Windows Azure\Virtual Machine\Password Reset\VM Access Extension issues	
	Azure Virtual Machine – Windows	Routing Azure Virtual Machine V3\Cannot Connect to my VM\I need to reset my password	Root Cause - Windows Azure\Virtual Machine\Password Reset\VM Agent not running/installed	

Troubleshooting Workflow

Please be aware the only portal validate for password complexity however Powershell, CLI or any other API does not

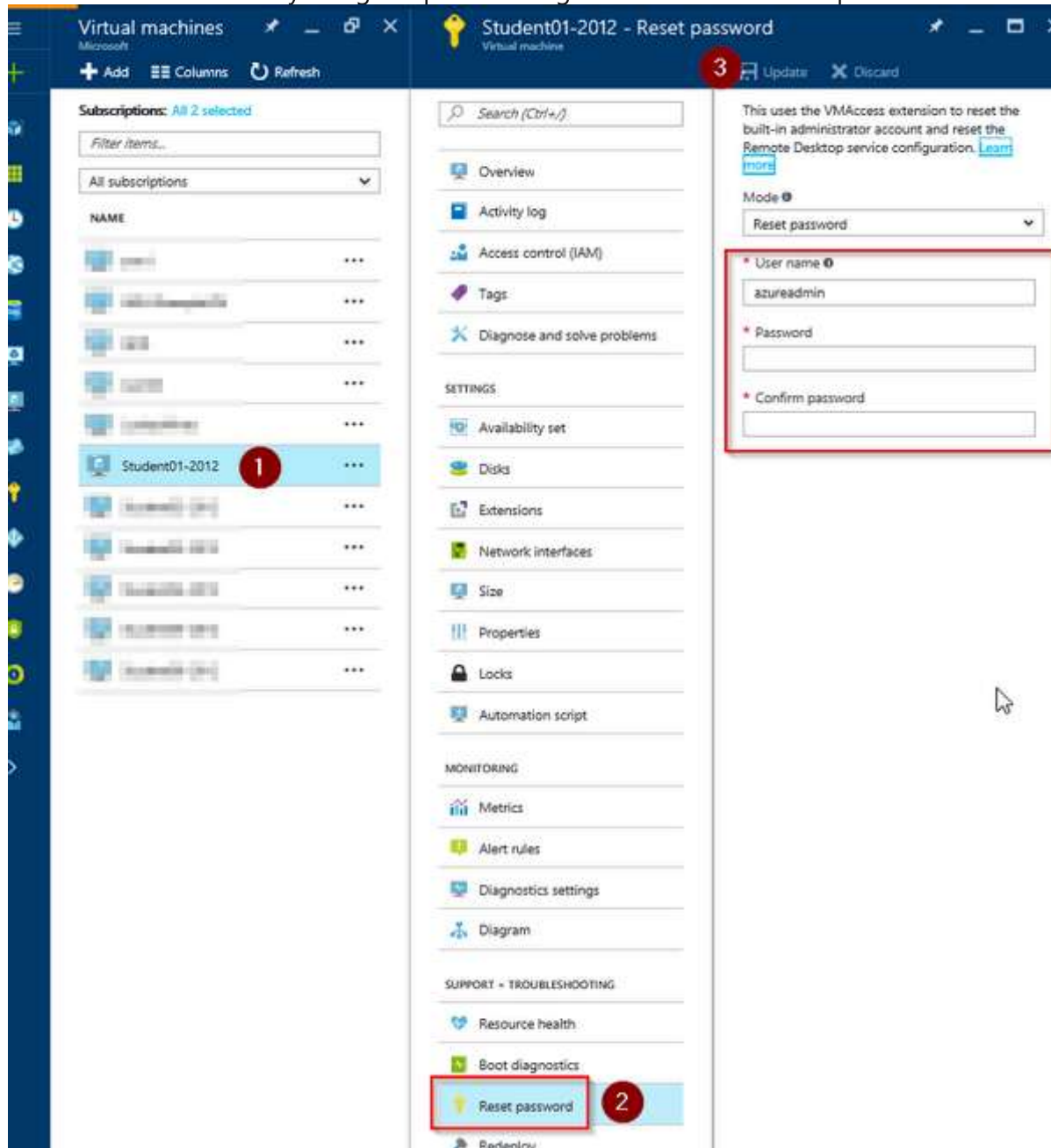
Linux VMs

▼ Click here to expand or collapse this section

Note: The process below is to reset the **root** ID. Be aware that to reset any other local ID, that needs to be done inside the Guest OS

1. For Linux machines, the Azure agent is a must so you could use the VMAccess extension to perform this reset:

1. You could use the GUI by using the portal. Using the **Reset Password** option on the Virtual Machine settings on the Azure Portal



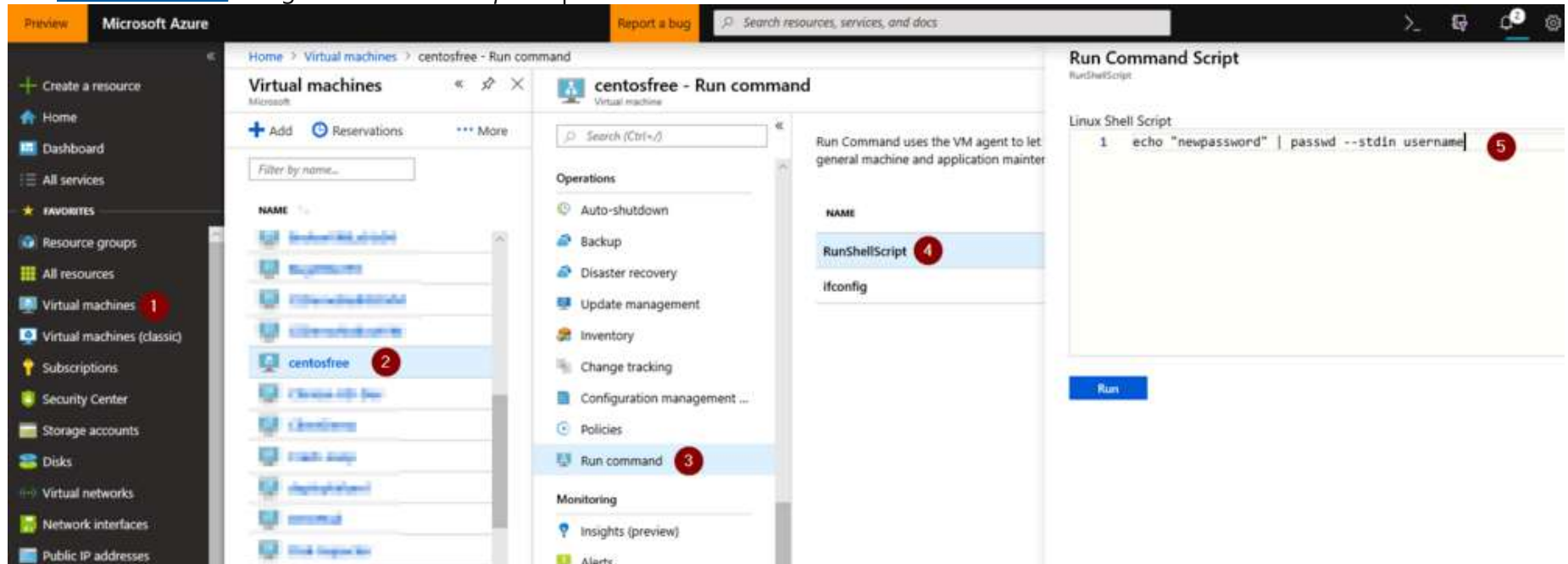
2. If the portal doesn't work, you could attempt to use [Azure CLI v 1.0](#)

1. For Classic (V1): *Not supported on RDFE*

2. For ARM (V2):

```
azure login
azure config mode arm
azure vm reset-access -g <<RESOURCE_GROUP_NAME>> -n <<VM_NAME>> -u <<USER>> -p <<PASSWORD>>
```

3. Use [Run command](#) using the *RunChsellScript* script



1. The script that you could execute to accomplish this task would be:

```
echo "newpassword" | passwd --stdin username
```

4. You could also use [Azure Cloud Shell - Azure CLI 2.0](#)

1. To reset a password

```
az vm user update --resource-group myResourceGroup --name myVM \
  --username myUsername --password myPassword
```

2. To reset an SSH key

```
az vm user update --resource-group myResourceGroup --name myVM \  
  --username myUsername --ssh-key-value ~/.ssh/id_rsa.pub
```



3. Using VMAccess Extension

1. To reset the password for a user, create a file named settings.json:

```
{  
  "username": "myUsername", "password": "myPassword"  
}
```



2. After creating your json file, use the Azure CLI to call the VMAccessForLinux extension to reset your SSH user credentials by specifying your json file:

```
az vm extension set --resource-group philmea --vm-name Ubuntu \  
  --name VMAccessForLinux --publisher Microsoft.OSTCExtensions --version 1.2 --settings settings.json
```



5. You could also use [Azure Powershell](#)

1. For Classic (V1):

```
Get-AzureVM -servicename <CLOUD SERVICE> -name <VMNAME> | Set-AzureVMExtension -ExtensionName VMAccessAgent -Publisher Microsoft
```



2. For ARM (V2):

```
$SubID = "<SUBSCRIPTION ID>"  
$RgName = "<RESOURCE GROUP NAME>"  
$VmName = "<VM NAME>"  
$Location = "<LOCATION>"  
  
Login-AzureRMAccount  
Select-AzureRMSubscription -SubscriptionId $SubID  
Set-AzureRmVMAccessExtension -ResourceGroupName $RgName -Location $Location -VMName $VmName -Credential (get-credential) -typeHa
```



6. To get a logging of this attempt and to troubleshoot, you could collect inspect IAAS Disk then this would be in ***/var/log/azure/Microsoft.OSTExtensions.VMAccessForLinux/1.4.6.0/extension.log*** to review further if they fail

2. If any of those options aren't working, you could attempt to do this reset manually inside the GuestOS by following the [Manual password reset on a Linux machine](#)

Windows VMs

▼ Click here to expand or collapse this section

Note: Please be aware that the VMAccess extension is designed to work **only with local IDs** and as the following:

- Given *an unknown local ID*, will create a new local ID and add this ID to the local Administrators group.
- Given *a known local ID*, will reset the password of this ID and ensure the ID is enabled.

This also means that VMAccess extension is designed not to work with Domain Controllers servers.

Ensure the scope of this password reset

1. If the customer wants *to reset a Domain IDs*, that cannot be done from the Azure Portal. Azure Portal uses the VM Extension and this will only create local ID account, this **is by design**. Update the product and support topic as following and transfer the case to Directory Services
 - Product: **Windows Svr 2008 R2 Datacenter** or **Windows Svr 2012 R2 Datacenter** or **Windows Svr 2016 Datacenter** as appropriate
 - Support topic: **Routing Windows V3\Active Directory\User, computer, group, and object management**
2. If the **only impacted IDs are Domain IDs** then:
 1. Ensure there's connectivity to the domain controller, if needed, you may need to engage *Azure Networking* on a problem
 - Product: **Azure Virtual Networks**
 - Support topic: **Routing Azure Virtual Network V3\Connectivity\Cannot connect to another virtual machine in the same VNET**
 2. If the connectivity with the Domain Controller is successful, you may want to engage *Directory Services* on a problem
 - Product: **Windows Svr 2008 R2 Datacenter** or **Windows Svr 2012 R2 Datacenter** or **Windows Svr 2016 Datacenter** as appropriate
 - Support topic: **Routing Windows V3\Active Directory\User, computer, group, and object management**
3. If the **only impacted IDs are local IDs** and the customer has access using Domain IDs then this is more likely to be either a profile issue or access level issue so route the whole case to *Directory Services* by updating the case as following:
 - Product: **Windows Svr 2008 R2 Datacenter** or **Windows Svr 2012 R2 Datacenter** or **Windows Svr 2016 Datacenter** as appropriate
 - Support topic: **Routing Windows V3\Active Directory\User, computer, group, and object management**

Reset Password on Scale Sets instances

1. Resetting the password on an instance from a Scale Set then refer to [Password reset for VMSS instances](#)

Reset Password on Domain Controller

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Currently this is being discussed with MSRC on best possible options for operations on DC's, any changes to custom script extension are extremely sensitive, due to large amounts of dependencies.

In terms of using Custom Script to restore access to a domain controller, **this is not supported and should not be done for a customer**, in addition this may break with changes to custom script in the future. If a customer loses access to a domain controller, then they need to follow the steps restoring the dc from backup, as they would do on-premises.

For more information please refer to [How to reset the Remote Desktop service or its login password in a Windows VM](#)

1. As explained earlier, this is not a supported scenario and the customer needs to restore from backup as they were already doing in on-premises. Please share with the customer the article on [AD Forest Recovery - Steps for Restoring the forest](#)

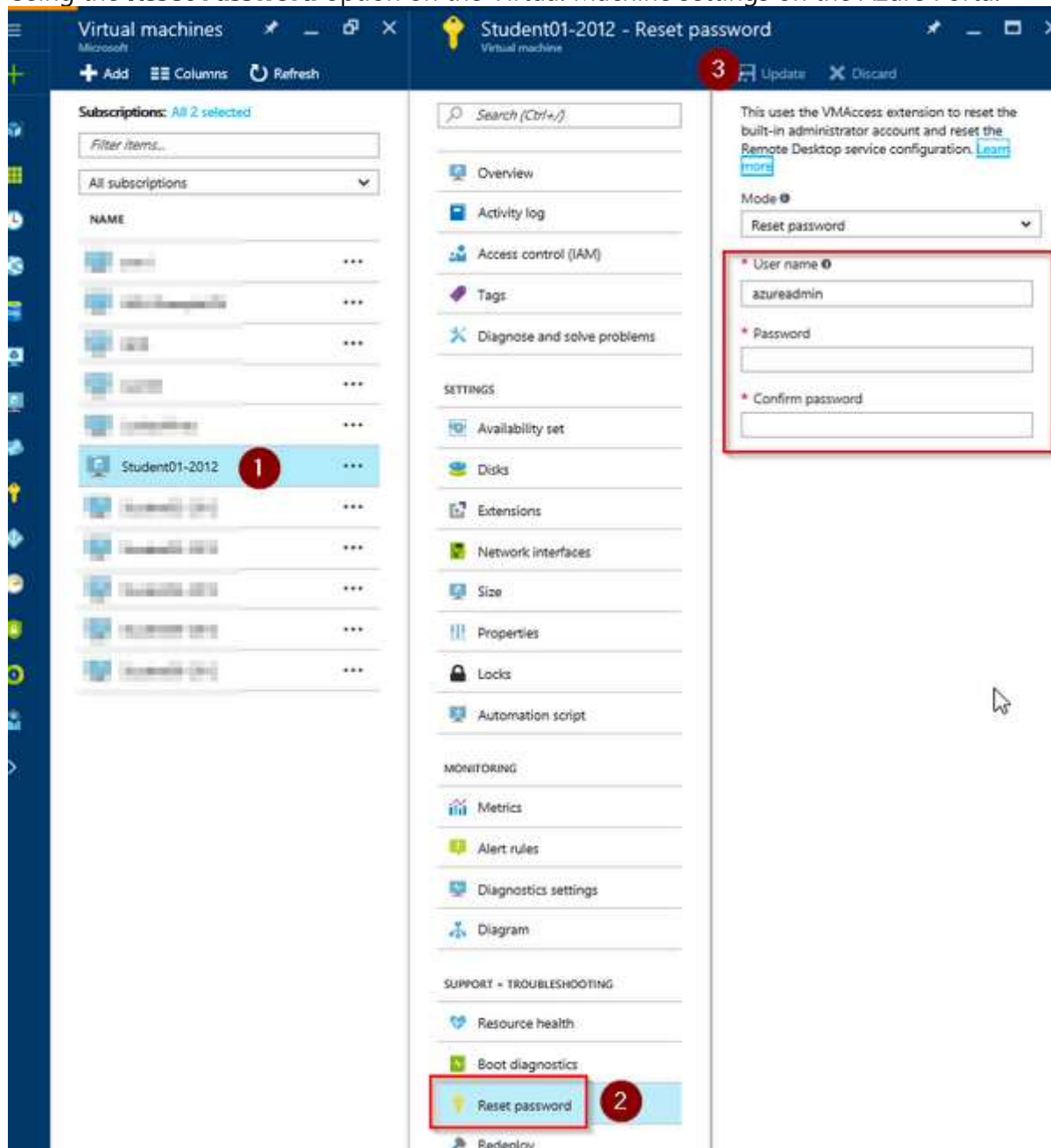
Reset Password on member or standalone server

Please update the customer that:

- Given *an unknown local ID*, will create a new local ID and add this ID to the local Administrators group.
- Given *a known local ID*, will reset the password of this ID and ensure the ID is disabled.

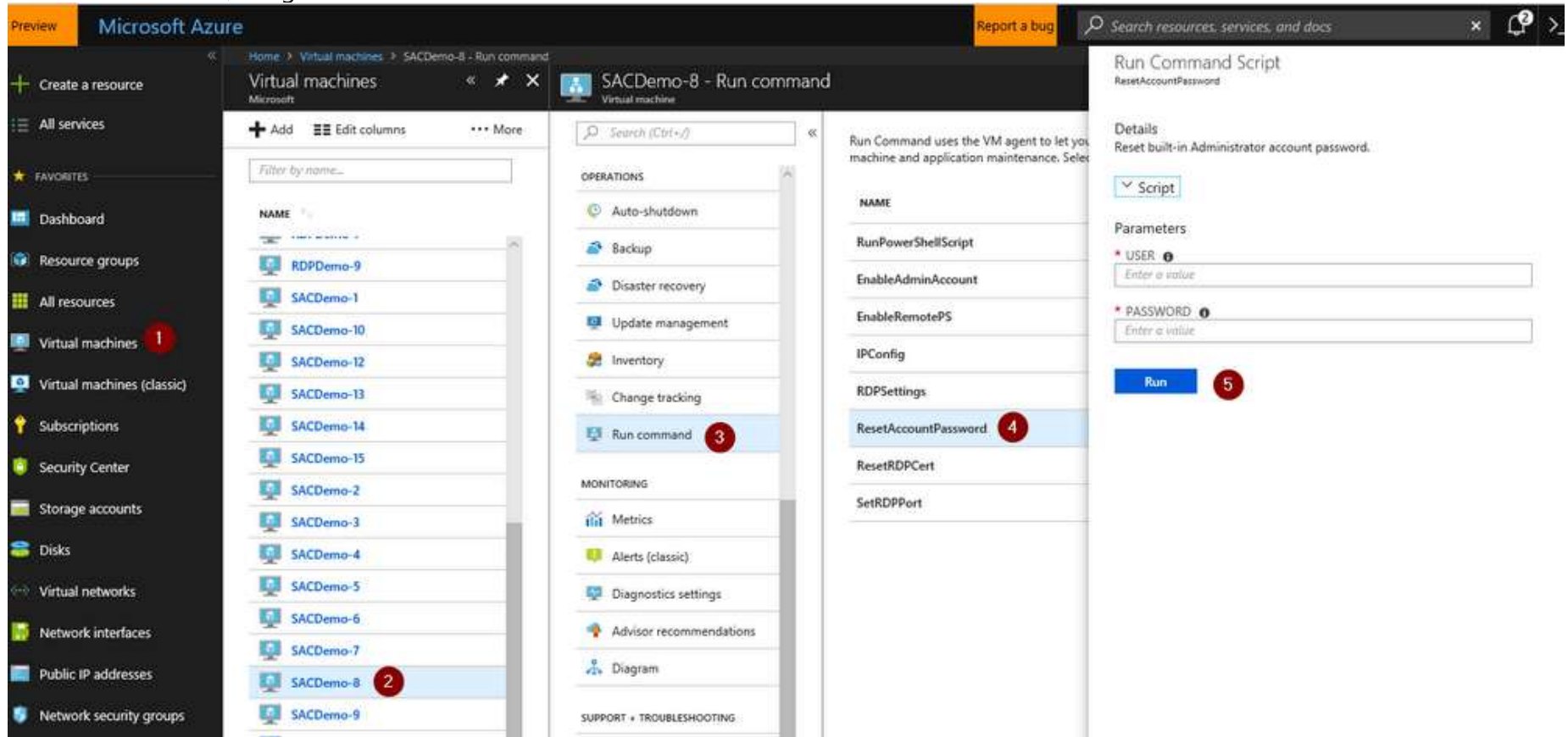
1. Using VMAccess Extension you have a few scenarios and signals:

1. Using the **Reset Password** option on the Virtual Machine settings on the Azure Portal



2. Use the **Serial Console Access**, refer to the *Online Troubleshooting* section in [Reset Password without VM Agent](#) on the Mitigation 2.

3. Use [Run command](#) using the *Reset Account Password*



4. Use the **Custom Script Extension**

1. You could run the [ResetPwd.ps1 script](#) from the customer powershell session. This will:

1. Create a Storage account
2. Create a container on that storage account
3. Upload a script on the storage account
4. Use CSE to push the script on our machine
5. This script will create a Local ID and will add this ID to the local Administrator group

2. Or you could do the upload of the script directly into CSE Using GUI, from the Azure Portal to push a script to updates an existing local admin account password, you can push the script [Reset Password CustomScriptExtension.ps1](#)

5. Using [Azure Powershell](#)

- For Classic (V1):

```
Get-AzureVM -servicename <CLOUD SERVICE> -name <VMNAME> | Set-AzureVMExtension -ExtensionName VMAccessAgent -Publisher Microsoft
```

- For ARM (V2):

```
$SubID = "<SUBSCRIPTION ID>"
$RgName = "<RESOURCE GROUP NAME>"
$VmName = "<VM NAME>"
$Location = "<LOCATION>"

Login-AzureRMAccount
Select-AzureRMSubscription -SubscriptionId $SubID
Set-AzureRmVMAccessExtension -ResourceGroupName $RgName -Location $Location -VMName $VmName -Credential (get-credential) -typeHa
```

6. Using [Azure CLI](#)

- For Classic (V1): *Not supported on RDFE*
- For ARM (V2):

```
azure login
azure config mode arm
azure vm reset-access -g <<RESOURCE_GROUP_NAME>> -n <<VM_NAME>> -u <<USER>> -p <<PASSWORD>>
```

7. If the User name / Password reset was successfully but customer still cannot login using the new credentials, or if it failed while VM guest is running, check the VMAccess Extension log. The VMAccess Extension log will indicate if the User name / Password reset was successful, and will include the exact error message for a failure (e.g. password doesn't meet complexity etc.). Collect inspect IAAS Disk then this would be in **\WindowsAzure\Logs\Plugins\Microsoft.Compute.VMAccessAgent\4.4\JsonVMAccessExtension.log**

8. If user is unable to login via RDP to Azure CIS Hardened Windows or Linux server images post deployment, confirm that the password complexity complies to the CIS Benchmark standard for that operating system [CIS Benchmarks](#) . Also refer to [Windows Image Password Complexity](#) .

2. If the VM doesn't have the VMAccess Agent or the extension is not working then follow the [Reset Password without VM Agent](#)

Need additional help or have feedback?

<i>To engage the Azure RDP-SSH SMEs...</i>	<i>To provide feedback on this page...</i>	<i>To provide kudos on this page...</i>
If you are in the OneVM team then reach out to the RDP-SSH SMEs AVA channel via Teams. If you are a VM Delivery Partner then follow your team's process for swarming or ask your TA. Make sure to use the Ava process for faster assistance.	Use the RDP-SSH Feedback form to submit detailed feedback on improvements or new content ideas for RDP-SSH. Please note the link to the page is required when submitting feedback on existing pages! If it is a new content idea, please put N/A in the Wiki Page Link.	Use the RDP-SSH Kudos form to submit kudos on the page. Kudos will help us improve our wiki content overall! Please note the link to the page is required when submitting kudos!